

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

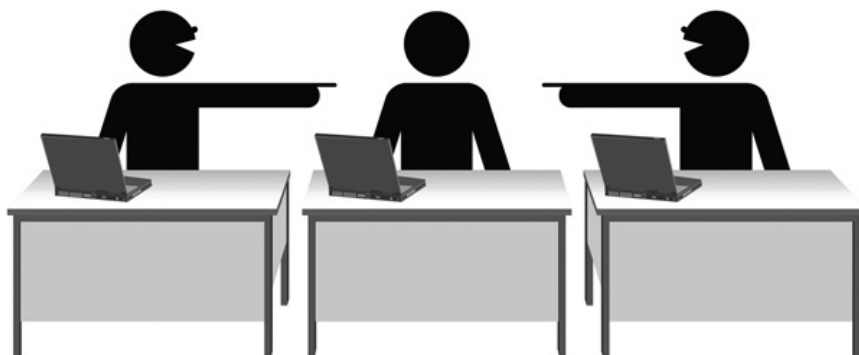
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Let's Start!

Do you have the right soft skills for the job?



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Soft skills are things like communicating with people, being organized and accepting responsibility. Do you think soft skills are important? Why or why not?
- Do you think you have these soft skills? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can request or report facts about events or actions related to work and jobs.
- I can express necessity and duty about a work-related process.
- I can exchange opinions about my academic studies and my work in various time frames.





Let's Explore!

Mr. Brody talks with his executive assistant, Ms. Walkers. He seems very **reflective***.

* To be "reflective" means you are thinking a lot about a problem or a situation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Martha: Good day, Mr. Brody.

Boris: Hello, Ms. Walkers.

Martha: You look very reflective.

Boris: Yes. You are a good executive assistant, Martha. You can read me well.

Martha: Oh, thank you.

Boris: I just met a young man who wants an editorial assistant position. Ever since meeting him, I've been thinking about what he said. It needs to be said: I like ambitious people.

Martha: Did you already give that position to someone? A young woman?

Boris: Yes, but you know, there's always room for talented people in our company. He doesn't have a lot of experience, but he demonstrated considerable soft skills while we were talking. He needs training, but he has great potential as a journalist.

Martha: Oh yes? Which soft skills did you see?

Boris: He was a great communicator. He gets along well with colleagues, listens and understands instructions, and gets his point across without being aggressive. He needs to be told that's something he's good at.

Martha: Oh, I agree.

Boris: I also saw evidence of creativity and problem-solving skills. He sees solutions as soon as he sees problems. Our organization needs shaking up a bit.

Martha: I know.

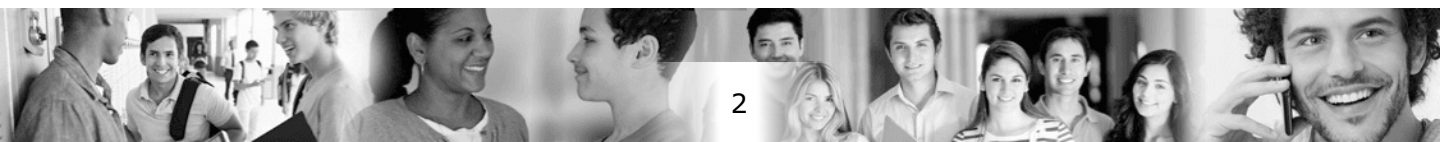
Boris: Also, I'm sure he is eager to accept responsibility. He takes pride in his work, and he is confident enough to put his name to it.

Martha: What are some other soft skills?

Boris: Well, the ability to work well under pressure is another one. Employers want to know you can put the stress to one side and focus on the job in hand. Once you have established your priorities, they need acting on. I think he can do that.

Martha: It sounds like you have another editorial assistant on your team.

Boris: Yes, perhaps you're right.



**Let's Practice!**

Boris tells Martha why he likes Adam.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct word on the line below. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. It needs are to be said I like ambitious people.

2. He needs to training, but he has great potential as a journalist.

3. He is needs to be told that's something he's good at.

4. Our organization needs to shaking up a bit.

5. Once you have established you priorities, they need to acting on.

**Let's Practice!**

Martha and Boris talk about Adam's skills.

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the options that you are given.

Word Bank

creativity / problem-solving skills / shaking up /
executive assistant / gets his point

1. You are a good _____, Martha.
2. He _____ across without being aggressive.
3. Our organization needs _____ a bit.
4. I also saw evidence of _____, he could come up with original ideas.
5. He also showed great _____. I think he is great at finding solutions to different problems.



Extension Activity

Make a list of soft skills and explain why they are important in today's market.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a list of the soft skills that were mentioned in this lesson.
- Go online. Find 4 - 5 more soft skills.
- For each soft skill, write 1 - 2 sentences explaining why this skill is important for finding and keeping a job. You can explain what would happen if the person didn't have this soft skill.
- Read your list and sentences to a partner.
- With a partner, discuss the soft skills and choose the three most important ones.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I read about soft skills.

☐ ☐

I write sentences explaining why soft skills are important.

☐ ☐

I discuss the importance of various soft skills.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **executive assistant** (noun): the person who helps the company president or CEO in a variety of ways, such as scheduling appointments.
e.g. You are a good executive assistant, Denise.
- **get your point across** (expression): to express your ideas clearly
e.g. He gets his point across without being aggressive.
- **to shake up** (verb): to make changes
e.g. Our organization needs shaking up a bit.
- **soft skills** (noun): personal qualities and abilities that are not related to direct training, but more about how a person interacts with others in the workplace
e.g. Which soft skills did you see?
- **creativity** (noun): the ability to come up with original ideas
e.g. I also saw evidence of creativity and problem-solving skills.
- **problem-solving** (noun): the ability to find solutions to problems
e.g. He showed evidence of creativity and problem-solving skills.





Learning Points

Expressing Necessity: **Need** + Passive Infinitive and **Need** + Gerund

You can use **need** + **passive infinitive** and **need** + verb *-ing* to talk about things that need to be done.

You use these structures to focus on the thing that needs doing, not the person who is doing it.

Subject + **Need** + **Passive Infinitive**

It needs to be said: I like ambitious people.

The subject of the sentence is the thing that needs doing.

Subject + **Need** + Verb *-ing*

Our organization needs shaking up a bit.

When you use **need** with a gerund (verb *-ing*), it has a passive meaning. It means that something needs to be done.

Examples:

- He **needs training**, but he has great potential as a journalist.
- Once you have established your priorities, they **need acting on**.
- All new employees **need to be trained** during the first week.

Time Clauses

You use time clauses to be precise about when an event or action occurred or will occur.

Remember, a clause has its own subject and verb. They can come at the beginning of a sentence (separated by a comma) or at the end of a sentence.

Look at the chart as a reference for different words or phrases used in time clauses and their meanings or uses.

Word/Phrase	Meaning/Use	Example
ever since	when things started	<i>Ever since meeting him, I've been thinking about what he said.</i>
while, as, whilst, when	things happening at the same time	<i>He demonstrated considerable soft skills while we were talking.</i>
as soon as, before, after, once	things happening at the same time	<i>He sees solutions as soon as he sees problems.</i>

